



1



2



3

275.102 TEAM 2026

From the advisory team
at Ye Tira Ahu Pair

YE TIRA AHU PAIR
MOSI KADARU
MOSI KADARU

BECOME A
CLASS REP
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Scan the barcode below to sign
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a Class Representative

or go www.mosikadaru.com.au
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Sign up
now

[illegible]

GETTING TO KNOW ONE
ANOTHER

Meet someone new

Your name

Where you are from

Something interesting about yourself

What is your favourite kai?



WHAKAWHANAUNGATANGA

From a Māori perspective, we declare:

- Who we are
- Where we are from
- Where we belong (whakapapa and marae)
- Identify connections
- Part of a connected group

7

COURSE 275.102

Start: Week 1 / 13 July 2026

Lectures:

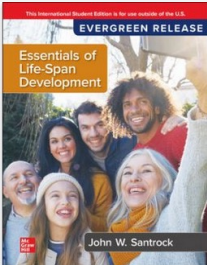
Thursday: 9-11am SNW100

Tutorials:

Friday: 11am- 12pm AT5

8

Textbook



Ngā rauemi | Course resources

EXTERNAL TOOL

Reading list

2. Read: Textbook

Read Chapter 1 pages 1-18 and pages 20-27. We will come back to pages 19-22 next week.

9

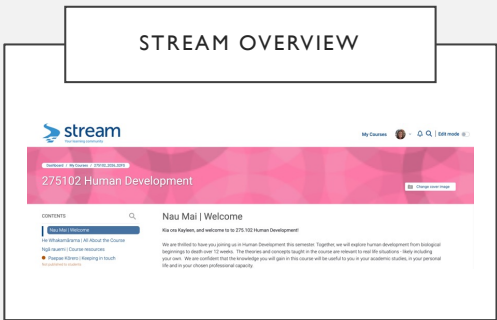
Connect E-Book



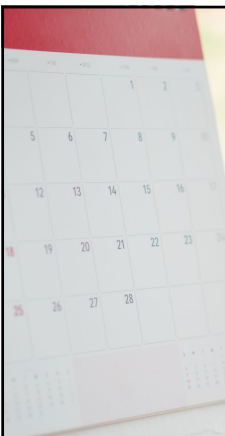
<https://video.mhhe.com/watch/TwqLUTximSCF2erPTmHi>

10

STREAM OVERVIEW



11



ASSESSMENT OVERVIEW

QUIZZES:
Online, open-book mastery quizzes (30%)
20 questions, 30 minutes
The best **four** scores for Quizzes 1-5 credited @ 7.5 marks each = 30 in total.

- Quiz 1 available from next week; quizzes 2-5 are available progressively throughout the semester.
- Each quiz is available for several weeks.
- Quiz 1 due **Fri, 9th August 2026**

Case Study Developmental Analysis:
Case study of selected topic

- A2 due **Fri, 23rd August 2026** – 30%
- A3 due **Fri, 11th October 2026** – 40%

Case study stories are available on Stream.

12

GOALS:
WHAT
ARE
YOUR
GOALS
FOR THIS
COURSE?

Clark Howard, Kayleen

Padlet

Human Development
course 275102: Goals
2026




[View results here!](#)

13

TODAY WE WILL DISCUSS:

Introduction

- What is lifespan development?
- Why do we study lifespan development?
- How do we study lifespan development?

14

WHAT?

The scientific study of how people develop physically, cognitively, and psychosocially across the lifespan.

15

HUMAN DEVELOPMENT THEORY

Theory:

- an orderly, integrated set of statements that provides an organising framework for observations.
- “an interrelated, coherent set of ideas that helps to explain phenomena and make predictions” (Santrock, 2024, p. 19).

Can be used to:

- Describe, explain and predict behaviour.
- Develop interventions to promote optimal development.

Theories form the backbone of research & practice (Nicolai et al., 2025).



16

Limitations of Theories



According to Nicolai et al. (2025):



Theories designed to describe, explain and predict behaviour. Generalising like this is convenient but nuance can be lost.



Theories are often conjectured by scholars or those in power following observations and then tested and revised based on additional testing.



Heavily reliant on who is doing the testing and observing, who is being observed/tested and under what conditions.



A space dominated by white, middle class participants -> white culture the norm.

Reference: Nicolai, K. D., Talib, T. L., Jackman-Ryan, S., Leigh Boyd, N., Zengilowski, A., Shukla, S. Y., & Chen, J. A. (2025). An anti-colonial approach to deconstructing and reconstructing educational psychology theories. *Contemporary Educational Psychology*, 80. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cedpsych.2025.102344>

17

Limitations of Theories

According to Nicolai et al. (2025):

- Theories are not culture free. What if the person interpreting the theory is from a different culture?
- Some dominant white theories have been appropriated from other cultures.
- Universalist or absolutist approach?
- Theories that dominate without scrutiny can cause harm.
- Viewing a theory as correct and applying to all has potential to ignore contextual factors and perpetuate faulty assumptions about race, class, and gender.
- Always ask, who is not seen? Who is not represented?

Reference: Nicolai, K. D., Talib, T. L., Jackman-Ryan, S., Leigh Boyd, N., Zengilowski, A., Shukla, S. Y., & Chen, J. A. (2025). An anti-colonial approach to deconstructing and reconstructing educational psychology theories. *Contemporary Educational Psychology*, 80. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cedpsych.2025.102344>

18

Our job is to...

Learn about	Recognise	Take
Learn about a range of developmental theories.	Recognise each theory has strengths, limitations and is positioned within a particular context.	Take what is useful for our knowledge and learning.

19

DEBATES IN THE HUMAN DEVELOPMENT FIELD

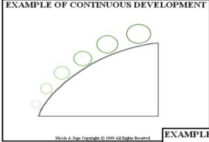
Nature: Genetic factors/heredity is biologically given
Stability: individuals who are high or low in a characteristic will remain so at later ages.

Nurture: Environmental factors: physical and social world
Plasticity : Change is possible and likely if new experiences support it.

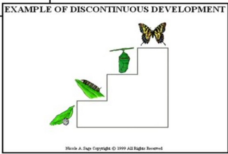


20

EXAMPLE OF CONTINUOUS DEVELOPMENT



EXAMPLE OF DISCONTINUOUS DEVELOPMENT



CONTINUOUS – NO STOP OR START (GRADUAL CHANGES)
DISCONTINUOUS – CAN IDENTIFY A STOP AND START (STAGES)

21



**DEVELOPMENT IS
LIFELONG:
FROM CONCEPTION
TO DEATH**

Developing throughout
our lives even into
adulthood: we can
identify different stages
from childhood into
adolescence and then
even in adulthood we
continue to develop

22

**DEVELOPMENT IS
MULTIDIMENSIONAL**

Within each period, change occurs in 3
broad domains which interact with each
other continuously





Physical
Development

Psychosocial
Development

Cognitive
(intellectual)
Development

23

**WHY DO WE
STUDY LIFESPAN
DEVELOPMENT?**

Group work: you need a scribe
and reporter

Discuss the why / what is value?

To help you – think of 3 words
or short phrases which you
associate with each stage of
development (Decades of life)

24

DECADES OF LIFE

Decade	Descriptor	Descriptor	Descriptor
0-9			
10-19			
20-29			
30-39			
40-49			
50-59			
60-69			
70-79			
80-89			

25

Decades of life

- 0-9 Innocence Immature Dependence
- 10-19 Rebellious Hormones Sex
- 20-29 Growth Independence Marriage
- 30-39 Family Marriage Work
- 40-49 Empty Nest Midlife Crisis Routine
- 50-59 Grandparents Divorce Self-care
- 60-69 Retirement Travel Health Decline
- 70-79 Alzheimer's Less Independence Assistnace
- 80-89 Wise Fragiliy Old Folks' Home

26

SO, WHY DO WE STUDY HUMAN DEVELOPMENT?

- To understand the normative developmental lifespan

This allows us to:

- Respond with appropriate community resourcing
- Support people appropriately
- Understand positive development across the lifespan

27






HUMAN DEVELOPMENT
RESEARCH?

28

THE ORIGINS OF YOU

- One of the goals of human development research is to see how childhood shapes later life.
- Blurb on back of the book "The Origins of you" (Belsky et al., 2023)
- At this very early stage, do you agree with the statements below:
 - Childhood temperament predicts adult personality.
 - Parents play an important role in shaping how a child matures.
 - Adolescence delinquency forecast a life of crime.
 - Genes influence success in life.
 - One's health is shaped by childhood experiences

29

UP NEXT


Next week


Questions & comments


Workshops

30

KARAKIA
TO CLOSE

Kua mutu a matou mahi
Our work has finished
Mō tēnei wā
For the moment

Manaakitia mai mātou
katoa
Bless us all
O mātou hoa
Our colleagues/friends
O mātou whanau
Our family
Āio ki te Aorangi
Peace to the universe
